

PELICAN BAY POLICE DEPARTMENT
FORENSIC SERVICES BUREAU — TRACE & IMPRESSION UNIT
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FORENSIC LABORATORY REPORT — TRACE & IMPRESSION EVIDENCE

Case No.: PBPD-2026-034532 | Document No.: 11

Lab Case No.: PBPD-T-2025-1024

Submitting Officer: Det. Yvette Landry, Badge #1887

Date Received (initial): October 4, 2025

Date Received (search warrant items): October 10, 2025

Date of Report: October 14, 2025

Reporting Analyst: Stephen Q. Caldwell-Beaumont — Senior Criminalist, Trace & Impression

Technical Reviewer: Demetria Walls — Latent Print/Impression Examiner

I. ITEMS EXAMINED

Scene items:

- E-11 — Partial shoe impression in blood, recovered via gelatin lift and electrostatic dust lifter from alley surface adjacent to victim's torso.
- E-13 — Single black synthetic fiber, ~2.4 cm, recovered from victim's right palm.
- E-14 — White paper napkin bearing handwritten notation "C-L. R.A. 10/3".
- E-16 — Black plastic shirt button, fractured (4 holes, ~11 mm diameter).
- E-17 — Cigarette ash deposit + control.
- AUT-W-1 through W-3 — Three wood splinters recovered during autopsy from Wound A (scalp), forwarded by Orleans Parish Coroner's Office.

Known reference items (from search warrants SW-2025-1144, 1145, 1146, executed at suspects' residences 10/10/2025):

- K-TC-01 — Vans Old Skool athletic shoes, men's size 11, US, black/white, mild blood-like staining at right outsole toe. From TRENT CORMIER's residence.
- K-TC-02 — Wooden baseball bat, full-length (32 in.), oak, with "Big Easy Souvenirs" laser engraving. Recovered from open trash receptacle on 1100 block of Burgundy St., outside K-TC residence. Bat shows fresh damage consistent with impact use; surface bears apparent cleaning residue.
- K-MP-01 — Red short-sleeve t-shirt, size XL. From MARCO PELLEGRINO's residence.
- K-KR-01 — Black pullover hoodie, size L. From KYLE ROBICHEAUX's residence.
- K-TC-03 — Light blue button-down shirt, size L, **missing third button from top placket**. From TRENT CORMIER's residence.

II. SHOE IMPRESSION ANALYSIS (E-11)

The partial impression measures approximately 3.8 in. × 2.6 in. and depicts the medial half of a left-foot outsole. Tread pattern, lug spacing, and the presence of a distinctive medial diamond-pattern logo block are consistent with the **Vans Old Skool** outsole design.

Test impressions were taken from K-TC-01 in both wet (blood-substitute) and dry conditions. **Class characteristics** — pattern, size, and design — are concordant between E-11 and K-TC-01.

Individual characteristics: Three randomly-acquired wear features were noted in K-TC-01: (a) a 4 mm cut in the medial waffle pattern at the second column, (b) a small embedded stone/inclusion in the heel block (not in the impression area), and (c) a wear-induced flattening of the third lateral diamond. Feature (a) is visible in the questioned impression E-11 in the corresponding location.

Opinion: K-TC-01 **could have made** the questioned impression E-11. One individual characteristic was identified in

the questioned impression that corresponds in location and shape to K-TC-01. Identification at the level of "identification to the exclusion of all other shoes" cannot be supported on the available print quality; the comparison is reported as **strong association**.

III. WOOD SPLINTER COMPARISON (AUT-W-1 through W-3 vs K-TC-02)

The wood splinters recovered from the victim's scalp were examined microscopically and via gas chromatography of resin extracts. All three are consistent with **white oak (Quercus alba)**. The bat K-TC-02 is engraved as oak and was confirmed via the same methods as **white oak**. The submitted bat exhibits surface damage (chipping, crushing of fibers) consistent with impact use and bears residual fiber loss in the same general grain pattern as splinters AUT-W-1 and AUT-W-2.

Wood species identification does not by itself provide a unique-source association. However, the combination of species concordance, the consistency of grain pattern in W-2 with the bat's chipped region, and the bat's physical condition supports the inference that the bat is a possible source of the splinters. Definitive physical fit could not be made; chips were small and partially fragmented during recovery.

IV. BUTTON COMPARISON (E-16 vs K-TC-03)

Button E-16, fractured, measures 11.2 mm diameter, 4-hole, black plastic, with a distinctive raised concentric ring at periphery. Buttons remaining on K-TC-03 are physically and chemically (FTIR) **indistinguishable** from E-16. K-TC-03 is missing the third button from the top placket; the remaining stitching at that location shows fresh tearing consistent with forceful detachment. Edge fracture of E-16 was compared microscopically to the remaining thread fragment on K-TC-03; a physical fit was not achievable due to thread damage but the comparison is otherwise highly concordant.

Opinion: K-TC-03 is the probable source of E-16, supported by FTIR, dimensional, and macroscopic comparison.

V. FIBER COMPARISON (E-13 vs K-KR-01)

Fiber E-13: black, synthetic, polyester (per FTIR), 24.8 µm diameter, trilobal cross-section, with characteristic delustering. K-KR-01 (hoodie) is composed primarily of polyester fibers **indistinguishable** in cross-section, diameter, color, and FTIR profile from E-13.

Opinion: Fiber E-13 is consistent with originating from K-KR-01 or another garment of the same manufacturing lot. Fiber comparison is a class-level association; this finding supports but does not uniquely identify the source garment.

VI. QUESTIONED-DOCUMENT EXAMINATION (E-14)

Notation "C-L. R.A. 10/3" was compared to known writings of Damari Thornton (recovered from his hotel room and from a notepad in his luggage). Author concordance is supported at the level of **probably written by** Damari Thornton. The notation is interpreted by the investigative team (not by this examiner) as referring to "Trent Cormier, Rusty Anchor, October 3." This examiner offers no opinion on meaning.

VII. LATENT PRINTS — BAT (K-TC-02)

Bat surface was processed with Sticky-Side Powder and small-particle reagent. The handle region was found to have been wiped or cleaned (apparent solvent residue, no friction-ridge detail recoverable). Two partial latent fingerprints of value were developed on the lower barrel taper. Comparison results:

- Latent L-1: Identified to **TRENT CORMIER** (left thumb).
- Latent L-2: Insufficient ridge detail for identification; suitable only for exclusion. Exclusions: Pellegrino, Robicheaux, victim.

Reporting Analyst: _____ A. Caldwell-Beaumont

Technical Reviewer: _____ D. Walls

Bureau Supervisor: Capt. Lawrence Boudin, FSB — 10/14/2025